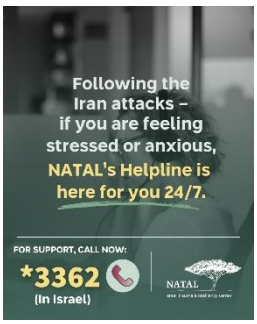
March 2026

Dear partners and friends,

Following two difficult days of relentless sirens and missile fire, lack of sleep, widespread destruction, psychological harm, and continuing uncertainty, we would like to provide our partners and supporters with an update about NATAL's activities.

On Saturday, February 28, 2026, a joint preemptive operation by Israel and the United States began against Iran. It is already becoming clear that the resulting psychological needs and damage are profoundly severe. The entire population of Israel is being exposed to an unprecedented level of continued threat, intense anxiety and traumatic incidents, the effects of which are compounded by the ongoing impact of events since October 7th.



In the 2 days since the inception of the latest war with Iran, NATAL's Helpline has experienced a 620% increase in calls. The overwhelming majority of calls were related to anxiety and fear due to the situation, particularly at night. This time, unlike during Operation "Am KeLavi" ("Rising Lion"), the intensity of the sirens has not permitted any respite, placing a particularly heavy burden on children, older adults, people with disabilities, and those coping with mental health conditions.

Key issues include:

- Concern for family members and reservists
- Difficulty in mediating and explaining the situation to children
- Lack of adequate protective shelter for many callers
- Panic attacks, acute fears of direct physical harm, and severe nighttime distress
- A high volume of calls from affected areas, including eyewitnesses to direct strikes.

Simultaneously, the "Nefesh Achat" ("One Soul") Helpline, operated by NATAL on behalf of the Rehabilitation Department of the Ministry of Defense, is also working in emergency mode. This Helpline provides support to disabled IDF veterans, former security service personnel, and their family members dealing with post-trauma, as well as veterans and reservists experiencing psychological distress and anxiety including due to having to report for reserve duty.

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The Clinical Unit has implemented a dedicated protocol for both new callers and ongoing patients.

The Unit's therapists are observing regression among some patients, requiring augmented psychiatric support and therapeutic adjustments. All therapy is currently being conducted online, and the clinical teams maintain proactive and continuous contact with patients.

Due to the increased caseload and this clinical deterioration, a dedicated internal emergency consultation line has been introduced to provide professional consultations for hundreds of NATAL therapists throughout the war.

In addition, NATAL is providing therapeutic intervention in the Tel Aviv and Jerusalem hotels hosting civilians whose homes were directly hit by missile strikes, to offer them ongoing support.

Community Work and Training

- We are conducting webinars and training sessions on emergency coping skills and on how to mediate the current situation for the general public, parents, therapists, and volunteers.
- The Multidisciplinary Trauma Studies Center is delivering situation-relevant training to NATAL staff and to therapists in the field.
- We are providing support and emergency interventions for first responders on the front lines.

Media Outreach

We are distributing coping tools for emergency situations across various media platforms and emphasizing the importance of preserving resiliency. At the same time, we are engaging in extensive media outreach to raise public awareness and are organizing specialized training and support for rescue personnel involved in life-saving operations in the field.

In times of national trauma, silence can sometimes be more deafening than any roar. People withdraw, communities contract, and the heart seeks protection. From our many years of professional experience, resilience is not the absence of suffering, it is the ability to remain together in the tremor, and to create meaning even from within a fracture.

In the words of Boaz Shalgi, Chief Psychologist of NATAL, "Uncertainty can weigh heavily upon us, especially when added to accumulated fatigue. Yet the knowledge

that our reaction is human and understandable, and that anchors of stability can be created even now, this is part of resilience. Resilience is not the absence of fear, but rather the ability to continue even amidst the turmoil".

In order to continue providing life-saving mental health assistance on an ever-increasing scale, we are now directing all organizational resources to our emergency response, along with preparations for long-term support, as the effects of trauma will continue to reverberate well beyond the restoration of calm.

Your support enables us to act swiftly and to scale capacity, with uncompromising professionalism. Thanks to you, we are able to reach thousands of people at their most vulnerable moments.

We will continue to provide ongoing updates and are happy to answer any questions that may arise.

With hope for more peaceful days,
Jude, Ruben and Efrat

Jude Yovel Recanati
NATAL Founding President

Ruben Krupik
Chair

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